Cipher Maps: Total Functions as Trapdoor Approximations

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Abstract

A cipher map is a total function on bit strings that approximates a latent function through a one-way trapdoor. We define four properties—totality, representation uniformity, correctness, composability—and show how they arise from three orthogonal construction layers (undefined injection, noise closure, multiple representations). We instantiate the abstraction against three concrete constructions: the HashSet (a space-optimal set membership structure), the entropy map (achieving Shannon-entropy-optimal value encoding), and the trapdoor Boolean algebra (an online construction supporting set operations via bitwise logic). We derive the composition theorem with proof, formalize the trusted/untrusted machine model, and present the Singular Hash Map—a construction achieving the information-theoretic lower bound of $-\log_2 \varepsilon + H(Y)$ bits per element.

1 Introduction

Consider a setting in which a trusted party wishes to outsource computation to an untrusted machine. The trusted party holds a function $f : X \to Y$—a lookup table, a set membership predicate, an index—and wants the untrusted machine to evaluate f on encoded inputs without learning f, X, or Y.

The central object of this paper is the *cipher map*: a total function $\hat{f} : \{0,1\}^n \to \{0,1\}^n$ that the untrusted machine evaluates blindly. The key insight is that $\hat{f}$ is total—every n-bit input produces an n-bit output, with no concept of "in-domain" or "out-of-domain." The notions of domain, correctness, false positive, and false negative exist only on the trusted machine, which holds the encoding and decoding functions (the trapdoor). The untrusted machine sees only opaque bit strings flowing through opaque total functions.

This paper develops the theory of cipher maps in a self-contained way. We define four properties that characterize a cipher map (§3), instantiate them against three concrete constructions from distinct domains (§4), formalize the trusted/untrusted machine model (§5), present the Singular Hash Map achieving space-optimal performance (§6), and prove the composition theorem governing error accumulation (§7).

What this is not. Cipher maps are not oblivious RAM [3]: ORAM reshuffles storage to hide access patterns with polylogarithmic overhead, while cipher maps use static total functions with noise injection. Cipher maps are not fully homomorphic encryption [2]: FHE preserves exact algebraic structure on ciphertexts, while cipher maps are approximate and hash-based. The closest relative is garbled circuits [4]—both use encrypted lookup tables—but garbled circuits are one-time use and exact, while cipher maps are reusable and approximate with noise closure.

2 The Cipher Map Abstraction

2.1 Definition

Definition 2.1 (Cipher map)**.** Let $f : X \to Y$ be a *latent function.* A *cipher map* for f is a tuple $(\hat{f}, \mathrm{enc}, \mathrm{dec}, s)$ where:

1. $\hat{f} : \{0,1\}^n \to \{0,1\}^n$ is a **total function** on n-bit strings;
2. $\mathrm{enc} : X \times \{0, \ldots, K(x)-1\} \to \{0,1\}^n$ is an encoding function, where $K(x) \geq 1$ is the number of encodings for element x;
3. $\mathrm{dec} : \{0,1\}^n \to Y \cup \{\perp\}$ is a decoding function;
4. s is a secret (the trapdoor) from which $\hat{f}$, enc, and dec are derived.

The untrusted machine holds $\hat{f}$. The trusted machine holds enc, dec, and s.

Remark 2.1 (Values as constant functions)*.* A cipher value $\mathrm{enc}(v, k)$ can be viewed as a cipher map for the constant function $f_v(x) = v$ for all x. Under this view, cipher values and cipher maps are the same kind of object—a total function on bit strings—simplifying the untrusted machine's interface.

2.2 Two Construction Strategies

Cipher maps arise from two fundamentally different construction strategies:

Batch construction. The trusted machine invests computation upfront to find a seed s such that $\hat{f}$ satisfies correctness constraints for all $x \in X$ simultaneously. This gives tunable correctness parameter η and optimal space, but requires knowing X and f at construction time. Examples: HashSet (§4.1), entropy map (§4.2).

Online construction. The cipher map $\hat{f}$ is defined directly by the hash structure—no seed search is needed. The secret s is a hash key, not a searched seed. Operations are limited to those the hash structure supports algebraically (e.g., set union, intersection). Space and accuracy trade-offs are fixed by the hash width n. Example: trapdoor Boolean algebra (§4.3).

Both strategies produce objects satisfying Definition 2.1.

2.3 Construction Layers

The four properties (defined in §3) arise from three orthogonal type transformations applied to the latent function.

Layer 1: Undefined injection. Extend the domain X to $X \cup \{\perp_1, \ldots, \perp_N\}$ by adding N undefined elements. A function $f : X \to Y$ lifts to a partial function $\tilde{f}$ that is undefined on the $\perp_i$. Real elements become a fraction $|X|/(|X| + N)$ of the extended type. This controls the space parameter ε (the probability that random bits form a valid codeword).

Layer 2: Noise closure. Lift the partial function $\tilde{f}$ to a total function $\hat{f}$ by mapping undefined inputs to random outputs via cryptographic hash. The untrusted machine cannot distinguish real inputs from undefined inputs—both produce n-bit output. This yields **Property 1 (Totality)**.

Layer 3: Multiple representations. Replace each value x with $K(x) \geq 1$ distinct representations, keyed by the secret s. Representational equality implies value equality, but value equality does not imply representational equality. Assigning $K(x) \propto 1/D(x)$ equalizes frequencies. This yields **Property 2 (Representation Uniformity)**.

The combined type is cipher(noise(undef(X)))—an element with multiple representations, total evaluation, and diluted domain. Properties 3 (Correctness) and 4 (Composability) are emergent: correctness depends on the construction method; composability depends on the totality guarantee enabling chained evaluation.

Remark 2.2 (Layers as conceptual scaffolding). We present these as conceptual layers explaining *why* each property exists, not as algebraic monads. Whether the layers satisfy formal monad laws in the approximate setting is an open question that we do not need to resolve.

3 Four Properties

A cipher map $(\hat{f}, \mathrm{enc}, \mathrm{dec}, s)$ for $f : X \to Y$ is characterized by four properties parameterized by $(\eta, \varepsilon, \mu, \delta)$.

3.1 Property 1: Totality

Definition 3.1 (Totality)**.** The function $\hat{f} : \{0,1\}^n \to \{0,1\}^n$ is *total*: for every $c \in \{0,1\}^n$, $\hat{f}(c) \in \{0,1\}^n$. For c chosen uniformly at random from $\{0,1\}^n \setminus \mathrm{Im}(\mathrm{enc})$, the distribution of $\hat{f}(c)$ is uniform over $\{0,1\}^n$ under the random oracle model.

Totality ensures that the untrusted machine cannot distinguish a real query $\mathrm{enc}(x, k)$ from a random filler string $c \leftarrow \{0,1\}^n$, because both produce n-bit outputs. If out-of-domain queries returned an error or $\perp$, the untrusted machine could identify real queries by observing which inputs produce valid output.

3.2 Property 2: Representation Uniformity (δ-bounded)

Definition 3.2 (Representation uniformity)**.** Let D be a distribution on X. Define the induced distribution on cipher values:

$$Q(c) = \sum_{x \in X} D(x) \cdot \frac{|\{k : \mathrm{enc}(x, k) = c\}|}{K(x)}. \tag{1}$$

The cipher map has *δ-representation uniformity* if

$$d_{\mathrm{TV}}(Q, \mathrm{Uniform}(\{0,1\}^n)) \leq \delta, \tag{2}$$

where d_{TV} denotes total variation distance.

Total variation distance has the operational interpretation that no statistical test can distinguish Q from uniform with advantage exceeding δ. To achieve small δ, assign $K(x) \propto 1/D(x)$ encodings per value (homophonic substitution), so that frequent values get more representations.

Remark 3.1 (Marginal uniformity only). Representation uniformity bounds the *marginal* distribution of individual cipher values. It says nothing about *joint* distributions: an adversary observing sequences of cipher values can still detect correlations. See §8.2 for the encoding granularity tradeoff.

3.3 Property 3: Correctness (η-bounded)

Definition 3.3 (Correctness)**.** For x chosen uniformly from X and k chosen uniformly from $\{0, \ldots, K(x) - 1\}$:

$$\Pr_{x,k}\big[\mathrm{dec}(\hat{f}(\mathrm{enc}(x, k))) \neq f(x)\big] \leq \eta. \tag{3}$$

The parameter $\eta \in [0, 1)$ is a *construction* parameter: it reflects how many constraints the seed s must satisfy. Tolerating $\eta > 0$ makes the seed search faster and the structure smaller. Once built, the failing elements are deterministic for a given seed—the same elements always fail.

Remark 3.2 (Approximation as privacy)*.* Nonzero η also provides privacy: a false positive creates plausible deniability, since the untrusted machine cannot distinguish "element is in the set" from "cipher map erred." With $\eta = 0$, the answer is deterministic; with $\eta > 0$, each answer carries ambiguity.

3.4 Property 4: Composability

Definition 3.4 (Composability)**.** Let $\hat{f}$ be a cipher map for $f : X \to Y$ with correctness η_f, and $\hat{g}$ a cipher map for $g : Y \to Z$ with correctness η_g. Define $\hat{g} \circ \hat{f} : \{0, 1\}^n \to \{0, 1\}^n$ by $(\hat{g} \circ \hat{f})(c) = \hat{g}(\hat{f}(c))$. Then $\hat{g} \circ \hat{f}$ is a cipher map for $g \circ f$ with correctness:

$$\eta_{g \circ f} = 1 - (1 - \eta_f)(1 - \eta_g) = \eta_f + \eta_g - \eta_f \eta_g. \tag{4}$$

Composability is enabled by totality: since $\hat{f}$ is total, its output is always a valid n-bit input to $\hat{g}$. The untrusted machine can chain cipher maps without needing to decode intermediate results. The proof of (4) is given in §7.

Remark 3.3 (Noise under composition)*.* Noise input to $\hat{f}$ produces random output (by totality). With probability ε, that random output happens to be a valid codeword for $\hat{g}$. We do not try to control noise output—the cipher map is just a hash. This is a feature: valid-looking outputs do not prove valid inputs.

3.5 Parameter Decomposition

Table 1: Cipher map parameters.

Parameter	Range	Controls	Determined by
η (correctness)	$[0, 1)$	Fraction of wrong answers	Construction (seed search)
ε (noise decode)	$(0, 1)$	Pr[random bits valid]	Encoding scheme
μ (value cost)	$(0, \infty)$	Bits per element for values	$\mu = H(Y)$
δ (uniformity)	$[0, 1]$	TV distance from uniform	Multiplicity $K(x)$
$K(x)$ (multiplicity)	$\{1, 2, \ldots\}$	Encodings per element	Set to $\propto 1/D(x)$
p (entanglement)	$\{1, \ldots, k\}$	Encoding granularity	Correlation structure (§8.2)

The space per element decomposes as:

$$\text{bits/element} = -\log_2 \varepsilon + \mu = -\log_2 \varepsilon + H(Y), \tag{5}$$

where $-\log_2 \varepsilon$ bits distinguish signal from noise and $H(Y)$ bits encode the function value. This decomposition is information-theoretic.

4 Concrete Constructions

We instantiate the cipher map abstraction against three constructions. For each, we identify which of the four properties are satisfied and with what parameter values.

4.1 HashSet

The HashSet is the simplest cipher map: an approximate set membership structure derived from a seed search.

Latent function. Set membership indicator: $f = \mathbf{1}_A : X \to \{0,1\}$ where $A \subseteq X$.

Construction. Choose a seed s such that

$$h(x\|s) = 0^n \quad \text{for all } x \in A, \tag{6}$$

where $h : \{0,1\}^* \to \{0,1\}^n$ is a cryptographic hash modeled as a random oracle. Membership test: declare $x \in A$ if and only if $h(x\|s) = 0^n$.

Mapping to cipher map abstraction.

- $\hat{f}(c) = h(c\|s)$, a total function on all bit strings.
- $\mathrm{enc}(x, 0) = x$ (single encoding per element; $K(x) = 1$).
- $\mathrm{dec}(r) = 1$ if $r = 0^n$, else 0.

Parameter instantiation.

Parameter	Value	Justification
η	0	All members hash to 0^n by construction
ε	2^{-n}	Random c satisfies $h(c\|s) = 0^n$ w.p. 2^{-n}
μ	≤ 1	Binary output
δ	N/A	$K(x) = 1$; no representation uniformity
Space	$n = -\log_2 \varepsilon$ bits/element	

Property status. Totality: **yes** (h is defined on all inputs). Representation uniformity: **no** ($K = 1$; cipher values are just domain elements). Correctness: **yes** ($\eta = 0$). Composability: **yes** (intersection of HashSets: $x \in A \cap B$ iff $h(x\|s_A) = 0^n$ and $h(x\|s_B) = 0^n$).

Remark 4.1. The HashSet demonstrates that the four properties are independent: a construction can satisfy some without others.

Remark 4.2 (Bits per element). The HashSet stores a single seed s, not per-element data. The quantity $\log_2(|U|/m)$ bits per element is the *amortized information content*: the total information required to specify which m elements belong to the set, divided by m. This is standard in the perfect hashing literature.

Construction complexity. Each candidate seed succeeds with probability $2^{-n|A|}$ (all $|A|$ elements must hash to 0^n), so the expected number of trials is $2^{n|A|}$. The space is $n|A|$ bits total, or $n = -\log_2 \varepsilon$ bits per element, matching the information-theoretic lower bound for membership (§6.1). The exponential construction time motivates the two-level construction of §6.

4.2 Entropy Map

The entropy map generalizes the HashSet to arbitrary functions $f : X \to Y$, achieving Shannon-entropy-optimal value encoding.

Latent function. Arbitrary $f : X \to Y$ where Y is finite.

Construction. Assign a prefix-free code $C_y \subseteq \{0,1\}^*$ for each $y \in Y$, where the fraction of hash space covered by C_y is proportional to $\Pr_D[f(X) = y]$. Find a seed s (via two-level hashing) such that

$$h(x\|s) \in C_{f(x)} \quad \text{for all } x \in X. \tag{7}$$

Evaluation: compute $h(c\|s)$ and decode via the prefix-free code.

Two-level hash (practical algorithm).

1. A primary hash maps x to a bucket index $j \in \{0, \ldots, b-1\}$.
2. For each bucket, find a local seed s_j such that $h(x\|s_j)$ decodes to $f(x)$ for all x in bucket j.
3. Store s_j in a seed table $H[j]$.
4. Query: compute bucket j (1 hash), evaluate $h(x\|H[j])$ and decode (1 hash). Total: $O(1)$ hash operations.

Construction time. Let ℓ be the number of items in a bucket. Each candidate seed succeeds independently with probability ε^ℓ (all ℓ items must land in valid codewords). The expected number of trials per bucket is $\varepsilon^{-\ell}$, geometric. Total expected construction time: $O(b \cdot \varepsilon^{-\ell})$.

Mapping to cipher map abstraction.

- $\hat{f}(c) = h(c\|H[\text{bucket}(c)])$, total function.
- $\text{enc}(x, 0) = x$ (simplest version; $K(x) = 1$).
- $\text{dec}(r) = y$ if $r \in C_y$ for some y, else $\perp$.

Parameter instantiation.

Parameter	Value	Justification
η	Construction-dependent	Fraction of bucket failures; near-zero with retry
ε	Code-dependent	$\Pr[\text{random bits} \in \bigcup_y C_y]$
μ	$H(Y)$	Shannon entropy of output distribution
δ	From code assignment	If $\lvert C_y \rvert \propto \Pr[f(X) = y]$, approaches uniform
Space	$-\log_2 \varepsilon + H(Y)$ bits/element	

Property status. Totality: **yes**. Representation uniformity: **achievable** (by assigning multiple codes proportional to output frequency). Correctness: **yes** ($\eta \approx 0$, tunable). Composability: **yes** (output is an n-bit string; serves as input to another cipher map).

Proposition 4.1 (Entropy map space)**.** *The space per element of an entropy map for $f : X \to Y$ with output distribution $(p_y)_{y \in Y}$ equals $-\log_2 \varepsilon + H(Y)$ bits, where $H(Y) = -\sum_y p_y \log_2 p_y$.*

Proof. The term $-\log_2 \varepsilon$ is the per-element cost of distinguishing signal from noise: each stored element requires that its hash prefix match a valid codeword, which occurs with probability ε for random inputs. The term $H(Y)$ is the expected code length under Shannon-optimal prefix-free coding, which equals the entropy of the output distribution by Shannon's source coding theorem. These two components are additive because the noise-rejection bits and the value-encoding bits occupy disjoint portions of the hash output. □

Remark 4.3 (Connection to Bloom filters). The entropy map for the set-indicator function $\mathbf{1}_A$ is analogous to a Bloom filter: two codewords ("member" / "non-member") allocated hash space in ratio $\varepsilon : (1-\varepsilon)$. The constructions differ—hash-based lookup vs. bit array with k hash functions—but the space bounds are related.

4.3 Trapdoor Boolean Algebra

The trapdoor Boolean algebra is an online construction: no seed search is needed, and set operations are performed via bitwise logic on hash values.

Latent function. Set operations over subsets of a string universe. Let X^* denote the free semigroup over alphabet X. The latent structure is the Boolean algebra $(\mathcal{P}(X^*), \cap, \cup, \complement, \emptyset, X^*)$.

Construction. Define a map $F : \mathcal{P}(X^*) \to \{0,1\}^n$ by:

$$F(\{x_1, \ldots, x_k\}) = h(x_1) \mid h(x_2) \mid \cdots \mid h(x_k), \tag{8}$$

where $\mid$ denotes bitwise OR and $h : X^* \to \{0,1\}^n$ is a cryptographic hash.

The operation correspondence is:

Lattice operation	Bit operation	Exact?
$A \cup B$	$F(A) \mid F(B)$	Yes
$A \cap B$	$F(A) \,\&\, F(B)$	Approximate
$A^\complement$	$\sim F(A)$	Approximate
$\emptyset$	0^n	Yes
X^*	1^n	Yes (limiting)

Why intersection is approximate. $F(A) \,\&\, F(B)$ retains all bit positions set in both $F(A)$ and $F(B)$. But $F(A)$ has bits set by *all* elements of A (not just $A \cap B$), and likewise for $F(B)$. When elements of $A \setminus B$ happen to set the same bit positions as elements of $B \setminus A$ (cross-element hash collisions), those bits survive the AND and appear as spurious bits. Formally, $F(A \cap B) \subseteq F(A) \,\&\, F(B)$ (as bit vectors), with equality only when there are no cross-element collisions.

Why NOT degrades with set size. $\sim F(A)$ flips all bits, giving the positions not set by any element of A. But $F(A^{\complement})$ is the OR of hashes of all elements not in A: for large complements, this converges to 1^n. Since $F(A)$ also approaches 1^n for large $|A|$, the NOT approximation $\sim F(A) \approx 0^n$ is poor when $|A|$ is large. NOT is most accurate when $|A|$ is small relative to n.

Relational predicates.

- Membership: $x \in_B W$ iff $h(x) \,\&\, F(W) = h(x)$.
- Subset: $A \subseteq_B B$ iff $F(A) \,\&\, F(B) = F(A)$.

Proposition 4.2 (Membership false positive rate)**.** *For random $x \notin W$ where $|W| = k$, under the random oracle model:*

$$\varepsilon_{\in}(k, n) = (1 - 2^{-(k+1)})^n. \tag{9}$$

Proof. Under the random oracle model, hash outputs are independent uniform bits. Each bit position j has $\Pr[h(x)_j = 1] = 1/2$ and $\Pr[F(W)_j = 0] = (1/2)^k = 2^{-k}$ (probability none of the k elements set bit j). Bit j causes a rejection (correctly identifying $x \notin W$) when $h(x)_j = 1$ and $F(W)_j = 0$, which happens with probability $2^{-(k+1)}$. All n bits must independently pass for a false positive: $\varepsilon_{\in} = (1 - 2^{-(k+1)})^n$. □

Space complexity. Single-level: $n = \log \varepsilon / \log(1 - 2^{-(k+1)}) = O(2^k)$ bits. This is exponential in set size. Two-level (practical): hash to 2^w bins of $(q - w)$ bits each. Total space $2^w(q - w)$ bits. False positive rate: $\varepsilon(k, w, q) = (1 - 2^{-(k/2^w+1)})^{q-w}$.

Mapping to cipher map abstraction. For the membership predicate on a set W:

- $\hat{f}(c) = c \,\&\, F(W)$, total function on all n-bit strings.
- $\mathrm{enc}(x, 0) = h(x)$.
- $\mathrm{dec}(r) = 1$ if $r = h(x)$ (where x is the queried element), else 0.

Parameter instantiation (membership predicate, set size k).

Parameter	Value	Justification
η	Operation-dependent	Union exact; intersection approximate
ε	$(1 - 2^{-(k+1)})^n$	Membership FP rate
μ	n bits (fixed width)	Entire set as single n-bit vector
Space	n bits total (not per element)	Constant-size; FP rate degrades with k

Property status. Totality: **yes** (bitwise operations defined on all n-bit strings). Representation uniformity: **marginal only** (see Remark 3.1 and §8.2). Correctness: **partial** (union exact; intersection/NOT approximate). Composability: **yes** (Boolean operations compose; error propagates via interval arithmetic).

Table 2: Comparison of the three constructions.

	HashSet	Entropy Map	Trapdoor Boolean Alg.
Construction	Batch	Batch	Online
Latent function	$\mathbf{1}_A$	Arbitrary $f : X \to Y$	Set ops on $\mathcal{P}(X^*)$
Totality	Yes	Yes	Yes
Rep. Uniformity	No ($K=1$)	Achievable	Marginal only
Correctness η	0	≈ 0 (tunable)	Union exact; $\cap/\neg$ approx.
ε	2^{-n}	Code-dependent	$(1-2^{-(k+1)})^n$
μ	≤ 1 bit	$H(Y)$	n bits
Space/element	$-\log_2 \varepsilon$	$-\log_2 \varepsilon + H(Y)$	n/k (amortized)

4.4 Construction Comparison

5 The Trusted/Untrusted Machine Model

This section formalizes the trust model implicit in the constructions above.

Definition 5.1 (Trusted machine T)**.** The trusted machine T holds: the seed s (trapdoor), the encoding function enc, the decoding function dec, and knowledge of which queries are real vs. filler.

T can:

1. Encode plaintext values: $x \mapsto \mathrm{enc}(x, k)$ for chosen k.
2. Decode cipher results: $r \mapsto \mathrm{dec}(r)$.
3. Inject noise: generate random $c \leftarrow \{0,1\}^n$ as filler queries.
4. Verify results: check $\mathrm{dec}(\hat{f}(\mathrm{enc}(x,k))) = f(x)$.
5. Reseed: construct a new cipher map with fresh s' when leakage accumulates.

Definition 5.2 (Untrusted machine U)**.** The untrusted machine U holds: the cipher map $\hat{f}$ (a total function on bit strings) and a collection of cipher values (encodings + filler, indistinguishable to U).

U can:

1. Evaluate cipher maps: $c \mapsto \hat{f}(c)$ for any $c \in \{0,1\}^n$.
2. Return results to T.

U cannot:

1. Decode cipher values (does not hold s or dec).
2. Distinguish real encodings from filler (by Property 1).
3. Determine the domain X or function f (by Property 2, cipher values are δ-close to uniform).
4. Enumerate which inputs are "in-domain" (by totality, every input produces output).

Protocol. The information flow is:

1. T encodes inputs: $\mathrm{enc}(x_1, k_1), \ldots, \mathrm{enc}(x_m, k_m)$.
2. T generates filler: $c_1, \ldots, c_r \leftarrow \{0,1\}^n$.
3. T sends all cipher values (real + filler, shuffled) to U.
4. U evaluates $\hat{f}$ on each cipher value and returns results.
5. T decodes the results it cares about; discards filler results.

What U observes is a sequence of n-bit strings as input and a sequence of n-bit strings as output. Under the four properties:

- Totality: every input produces output; no error signals leak domain information.
- Representation uniformity: cipher values are δ-close to uniform; frequency analysis is bounded by δ.
- Correctness: irrelevant to U (only T decodes).
- Composability: U can chain cipher maps without decoding intermediate results.

Table 3: What the four properties guarantee against U.

Adversary capability	Prevented by	Mechanism
Distinguish real from filler	Totality	All queries produce output
Frequency analysis	Rep. uniformity	Values δ-close to uniform
Learn function values	Trapdoor	Cannot invert h without s
Enumerate domain X	Totality + trapdoor	Cannot test membership
Detect query correlations	**Not fully**	Only marginal uniformity

The last row is the honest limitation: the four properties do not provide full correlation hiding unless the encoding granularity encompasses the correlated values (§8.2).

6 The Singular Hash Map

The Singular Hash Map is a concrete cipher map construction achieving the information-theoretic space lower bound. It combines the entropy map's prefix-free coding with a global seed search.

6.1 Information-Theoretic Lower Bound

Theorem 6.1 (Lower bound)**.** *Any data structure representing an approximate map $\hat{f}$ for $f : X \to Y$ with noise decode probability ε and correctness $\eta = 0$ over n stored elements requires at least*

$$n\big(-\log_2 \varepsilon + H(Y)\big) \text{ bits,} \tag{10}$$

or equivalently $-\log_2 \varepsilon + H(Y)$ bits per element.

Proof. The bound decomposes into two independent information requirements.

Membership component. Consider the membership predicate $\mathrm{dec}(\hat{f}(c)) \neq \perp$. For a universe U with $|U| \gg n$, the structure must distinguish n stored elements from $|U| - n$ non-elements, with at most an ε fraction of non-elements decoding to valid output. There are $\binom{|U|}{n}$ possible sets of size n from a universe U. Any representation must distinguish all such sets, requiring at least $\log_2 \binom{|U|}{n}$ bits. For $|U| \gg n$, Stirling's approximation gives $\log_2 \binom{|U|}{n} \approx n \log_2(|U|/n)$ bits, or $\log_2(|U|/n)$ bits per element. Setting $\varepsilon = n/|U|$ (the fraction of the universe that decodes validly), this is $n \log_2(1/\varepsilon)$ bits.

Value component. Independently of membership, the structure must encode the function values $(f(x_1), \ldots, f(x_n))$. By Shannon's source coding theorem, encoding n independent draws from the distribution (p_y) requires at least $nH(Y)$ bits.

Since membership and value encoding are jointly necessary, the total requirement is $n(-\log_2 \varepsilon + H(Y))$ bits. The additivity holds because the membership bits and value-encoding bits convey independent information: by the entropy chain rule, $H(\text{membership}, \text{value}) = H(\text{membership}) + H(\text{value} \mid \text{membership})$, and conditioning on membership (i.e., knowing which elements are stored) does not reduce the entropy of the value assignment, since the values $(f(x_1), \ldots, f(x_n))$ are an independent degree of freedom. □

6.2 Construction

Algorithm 1 Singular Hash Map Construction

```
function BuildCipherMap(M, enc, dec, h)
    ℓ ← 0
    while true do
        success ← true
        for (x, y) ∈ M do
            hash ← h(ℓ) ⊕ h(x)                    ▷ XOR combines seed with key
            if dec(hash) ≠ y then
                success ← false; break
            end if
        end for
        if success then
            return CipherMap(h, dec, ℓ)
        end if
        ℓ ← ℓ + 1
    end while
end function
```

The construction searches for a seed ℓ such that for every $(x, y) \in M$, the hash $h(\ell) \oplus h(x)$ decodes to y under the prefix-free code. Query evaluation computes $\hat{f}(c) = h(\ell) \oplus h(c)$ and decodes the result.

Remark 6.1 (Construction with $\eta > 0$). Algorithm 1 implements the $\eta = 0$ special case. For $\eta > 0$, the search accepts any seed for which at most $\lfloor \eta \cdot m \rfloor$ elements fail correctness. This relaxation reduces expected construction time since fewer constraints must be simultaneously satisfied.

6.3 Space Optimality

Theorem 6.2 (Space complexity)**.** *The Singular Hash Map achieves space complexity*

$$(1-\eta)\big(-\log_2 \varepsilon + \mu\big) \text{ bits per element,} \tag{11}$$

where $\mu = H(Y)$ is the mean encoding length. When $\eta = 0$, this matches the lower bound of Theorem 6.1.

Proof. Step 1: False negative reduction. When false negatives are permitted at rate η, only $(1-\eta)n$ of the n elements must decode correctly, reducing the effective element count.

Step 2: Per-element bit cost. For each stored element x_i, the hash $h(\ell) \oplus h(x_i)$ must decode to $f(x_i)$ under the prefix-free code. Under the random oracle model, the probability of correct decode for element x_i with target value y_i is $2^{-|c_{y_i}|}$, where $|c_{y_i}|$ is the code length. By Shannon-optimal coding, $|c_{y_i}| \approx -\log_2 p_{y_i}$, so the expected code length per element is $\sum_y p_y |c_y| = \mu = H(Y)$.

Step 3: False positive control. For non-stored elements $x \notin M$, the hash $h(\ell) \oplus h(x)$ is uniformly distributed under the random oracle model. The probability of decoding to *any* valid output is ε (the total probability mass of the prefix-free code). Achieving target rate ε requires $-\log_2 \varepsilon$ bits of hash beyond the value encoding.

Step 4: Combining. Each stored element costs $-\log_2 \varepsilon + \mu$ bits, and $(1-\eta)n$ elements are stored, giving total space $(1-\eta)n(-\log_2 \varepsilon + \mu)$ bits. □

Corollary 6.3 (Asymptotic optimality)**.** *When $\eta = 0$, the Singular Hash Map achieves $-\log_2 \varepsilon + H(Y)$ bits per element, matching the information-theoretic lower bound.*

6.4 Construction Time

Proposition 6.4 (Expected construction trials)**.** *For $m = (1-\eta)n$ stored elements, the probability of successful construction for a given seed ℓ is:*

$$p = \prod_{i=1}^{m} (1 - e_i), \tag{12}$$

where $e_i = 1 - 2^{-|c_{y_i}|}$ is the per-element failure probability. The expected number of trials is $1/p$.

Proof. Under the random oracle model, the hash values $h(\ell) \oplus h(x_i)$ for distinct x_i are independent uniformly distributed bit strings. For element x_i with target value y_i, correct decoding requires the hash prefix to match code c_{y_i}, which occurs with probability $2^{-|c_{y_i}|}$. Independence across elements gives the product formula. The number of trials is geometric with success probability p. □

7 Composition

7.1 Warm-Up: The AND Gate

Before proving the general composition theorem, we analyze a concrete case: the AND gate operating on two independent Bernoulli Boolean values B_1, B_2 with correctness probabilities $p_1 = 1 - \eta_1$ and $p_2 = 1 - \eta_2$.

Proposition 7.1 (AND gate correctness)**.** *The correctness probability of* $\mathrm{AND}(B_1, B_2)$ *as an approximation of* $\mathrm{AND}(x_1, x_2)$ *depends on the latent inputs:*

x_1	x_2	$\mathrm{AND}(x_1, x_2)$	$\Pr[\textit{correct}]$
1	1	1	$p_1 p_2$
1	0	0	$1 - p_1(1 - p_2)$
0	1	0	$1 - p_2(1 - p_1)$
0	0	0	$p_1 + p_2 - p_1 p_2$

Proof. We verify the $(1, 0)$ case; the others are analogous. When $x_1 = 1$, $x_2 = 0$, the correct output is 0. The output is wrong ($= 1$) only when $B_1 = 1$ (correct, probability p_1) *and* $B_2 = 1$ (incorrect, probability $1 - p_2$). So $\Pr[\text{wrong}] = p_1(1 - p_2)$ and $\Pr[\text{correct}] = 1 - p_1(1 - p_2) = 1 - p_1 + p_1 p_2$. □

The output is a *4th-order Bernoulli Boolean*: four distinct correctness probabilities despite the Boolean type having only two values. Rather than tracking all four, we can bound them by an interval $[\min_{\text{cases}} p_{\text{correct}},\ \max_{\text{cases}} p_{\text{correct}}]$. For AND with $p_1, p_2 \in (0.5, 1)$: minimum $p_1 p_2$ (case $(1, 1)$); maximum $p_1 + p_2 - p_1 p_2$ (case $(0, 0)$).

7.2 General Composition Theorem

Theorem 7.2 (Composition correctness)**.** *Let $\hat{f}$ be a cipher map for $f : X \to Y$ with correctness η_f, and $\hat{g}$ a cipher map for $g : Y \to Z$ with correctness η_g. Then $\hat{g} \circ \hat{f}$ is a cipher map for $g \circ f$ with correctness:*

$$\eta_{g \circ f} = 1 - (1 - \eta_f)(1 - \eta_g) = \eta_f + \eta_g - \eta_f \eta_g. \tag{13}$$

Proof. The composition is correct when *both* maps produce correct results. We establish two bounds.

Upper bound (union bound).

$$\Pr[\text{incorrect}] \leq \Pr[\hat{f} \text{ incorrect}] + \Pr[\hat{g} \text{ incorrect}] = \eta_f + \eta_g. \tag{14}$$

Tight bound (independence). Assume: (i) $\hat{f}$ and $\hat{g}$ use independent seeds, and (ii) $\hat{g}$'s correctness on $\hat{f}(c)$ is independent of whether $\hat{f}$ was correct (re-randomization: the encoding fed to $\hat{g}$ is a fresh random valid encoding of $f(x)$). Then

$$\Pr[\text{both correct}] = (1 - \eta_f)(1 - \eta_g), \tag{15}$$

giving $\eta_{g \circ f} = 1 - (1 - \eta_f)(1 - \eta_g) = \eta_f + \eta_g - \eta_f \eta_g$. □

Remark 7.1 (Independence assumption)*.* Condition (ii) (re-randomization) deserves care. In practice, $\hat{f}$ produces a *specific* encoding of $f(x)$, not a uniformly random one. If $\hat{g}$'s correctness depends on *which* encoding it receives, the errors may be correlated. The formula is therefore best understood as an upper bound under the weaker assumption that errors are positively correlated. For specific circuits, the case-by-case analysis from §7.1 (interval arithmetic) gives tighter bounds.

Remark 7.2 (Garbage propagation)*.* When $\hat{f}$ produces an incorrect output on some input, the value fed to $\hat{g}$ is effectively random. Since $\hat{g}$ is a total function, it produces *some* output on this random input, which is correct with probability at most ε_g (the noise-decode probability of $\hat{g}$). Thus the bound $\eta_{\text{total}} \leq \eta_f + \eta_g - \eta_f \eta_g$ is an upper bound; the actual error rate may be marginally lower due to accidental correctness on garbage inputs. For small η_f, η_g, this distinction is negligible.

7.3 Composition Chains

Corollary 7.3 (Chain composition)**.** *For a chain of m cipher maps $\hat{f}_1, \ldots, \hat{f}_m$:*

$$\eta_{\text{total}} = 1 - \prod_{i=1}^{m}(1 - \eta_i). \tag{16}$$

If all $\eta_i = \eta$:

$$\eta_{\text{total}} = 1 - (1 - \eta)^m \approx m\eta \quad \textit{for small } \eta. \tag{17}$$

Proof. By induction on Theorem 7.2. The base case $m = 2$ is the theorem. For the inductive step, the composition of $m - 1$ maps has correctness $1 - \prod_{i=1}^{m-1}(1 - \eta_i)$; composing with $\hat{f}_m$ gives $1 - \prod_{i=1}^{m-1}(1 - \eta_i) \cdot (1 - \eta_m) = 1 - \prod_{i=1}^{m}(1 - \eta_i)$. The approximation follows from $\ln(1 - \eta) \approx -\eta$ for small η, giving $(1 - \eta)^m \approx e^{-m\eta} \approx 1 - m\eta$. □

Example 7.1. A circuit of 100 cipher maps each with $\eta = 10^{-6}$: $\eta_{\text{total}} = 1 - (1 - 10^{-6})^{100} \approx 10^{-4}$.

7.4 Error Accumulation by Gate Type

For specific circuits, the AND gate analysis (Proposition 7.1) can be extended to OR, NOT, and arbitrary Boolean gates. Each gate type induces a different case table. Rather than tracking exact correctness per case, interval arithmetic propagates bounds: at each gate, compute $[\eta_{\min}, \eta_{\max}]$ from the input intervals. This gives input-dependent bounds tighter than the worst-case Theorem 7.2.

8 Representation Uniformity and Encoding Granularity

8.1 Total Variation Distance

Definition 8.1 (Total variation distance)**.** Let P and Q be distributions on a finite set Ω. The total variation distance is:

$$d_{\text{TV}}(P, Q) = \frac{1}{2} \sum_{\omega \in \Omega} |P(\omega) - Q(\omega)| = \max_{A \subseteq \Omega} |P(A) - Q(A)|. \tag{18}$$

TV distance has the operational interpretation: no test can distinguish P from Q with advantage greater than $d_{\text{TV}}(P, Q)$. This directly bounds what an adversary observing cipher values can learn.

Remark 8.1. Max-divergence (D_∞) would give a stronger guarantee (bounding the *ratio* of probabilities rather than the difference) but is harder to achieve. We use TV distance because the constructions are designed around frequency equalization, which naturally yields TV bounds.

8.2 The Encoding Granularity Principle

Representation uniformity is defined *per cipher map*. What correlations it hides depends on what is encoded as a unit.

Definition 8.2 (Encoding granularity)**.** The *encoding granularity* of a cipher map $\hat{f}$ for $f : X \to Y$ is the type X. Representation uniformity applies to the distribution over encodings of individual elements of X.

Consider encrypting a pair of Boolean values (a, b) where a and b are correlated.

Component-wise encoding ($p = 1$). Encode a and b as separate cipher values. Each component's marginal distribution is δ-close to uniform, but joint correlations leak.

Pair-wise encoding ($p = 2$). Encode (a, b) as a single cipher value. The distribution over pair encodings is δ-close to uniform; correlations between a and b are hidden. Cost: domain is $\{0, 1\}^2$ (4 elements) rather than $\{0, 1\}$ (2 elements); space per encoding grows.

Whole-state encoding ($p = k$). Encode the entire program state as one cipher value. All correlations are hidden. Cost: domain is the full state space, typically prohibitive.

Definition 8.3 (Entanglement parameter)**.** For a system encoding k correlated Boolean values, the *entanglement parameter* p is the number of values encoded as a single unit. The system has type $\text{cipher}(\{0, 1\}^p)^{k/p}$, where each block of p bits is encoded jointly.

Proposition 8.1 (Granularity and privacy)**.** *Let $\hat{f}$ be a cipher map for $f : X_1 \times X_2 \to Y$ with representation uniformity δ. Then the marginal distribution of $\text{enc}((x_1, x_2), k)$ over random $(x_1, x_2) \sim D$ and random k is δ-close to uniform, and the joint distribution of (x_1, x_2) is hidden up to δ.*

Conversely, let $\hat{f}_1, \hat{f}_2$ be independent cipher maps for $f_1 : X_1 \to Y_1$ and $f_2 : X_2 \to Y_2$, each with representation uniformity δ. Then each marginal cipher value is δ-close to uniform, but correlations between x_1 and x_2 are ***not hidden****, even when $\delta = 0$.*

Proof. The first part follows directly from Definition 3.2 applied to the joint cipher map. For the second part: even with $\delta = 0$ (perfect marginal uniformity), enc_i is a deterministic function of (x_i, k_i). An adversary observing N draws of $(\text{enc}_1(x_1, k_1), \text{enc}_2(x_2, k_2))$ can estimate the joint distribution and recover the correlation structure of (x_1, x_2), because the correlation structure under D is preserved in the joint distribution of cipher value pairs. □

The trade-off. Coarser encoding granularity (larger p) yields better privacy but requires more space and construction time. Composition exists precisely because encoding the entire program as a single cipher value is impractical: we compose smaller cipher maps and accept that intermediate correlations may leak.

Honest limitations.

1. Marginal uniformity says nothing about joint distributions.
2. Encoding granularity is a design choice, not a property of the formalism.
3. Equality pattern leakage is fundamental: any deterministic encoding leaks the equality pattern of its inputs. Multiple representations ($K(x) > 1$) reduce but do not eliminate this.

9 Discussion

9.1 Relationship to the Bernoulli Model

The correctness parameter η of a cipher map corresponds directly to the error rate in a Bernoulli approximation. A cipher map with correctness η induces a Bernoulli approximation of the latent function f: for each $x \in X$, $\Pr[\text{dec}(\hat{f}(\text{enc}(x, k))) \neq f(x)] = \eta(x)$, where the failing elements are deterministic for a given seed.

The composition formula $\eta_{g \circ f} = 1 - (1 - \eta_f)(1 - \eta_g)$ is the standard error accumulation for independent Bernoulli events, identical to the formula derived in the noisy gates framework for AND

gates over Bernoulli Booleans. This is not coincidental: a cipher map *is* a Bernoulli approximation, viewed through the lens of hash-based total functions.

9.2 Algebraic Structure

The cipher map abstraction relates to algebraic concepts from the theory of monoid homomorphisms. The decoding function dec is (by construction) a left inverse of enc, and for cipher maps that preserve algebraic structure (e.g., the trapdoor Boolean algebra), dec is a homomorphism from the cipher monoid to the latent monoid—but only up to the equivalence $c_1 \sim c_2 \iff \mathrm{dec}(c_1) = \mathrm{dec}(c_2)$. The quotient $\{0,1\}^n/\!\sim$ is isomorphic to the latent structure.

We note this connection but do not develop it further. The category-theoretic framing (cipher functors lifting monoids to cipher monoids) is a natural extension but requires careful treatment of the approximate setting: the functor laws hold exactly on the quotient but only approximately on representatives.

9.3 Open Questions

1. **Max-divergence vs. TV distance for δ.** TV distance bounds distinguishing advantage; max-divergence (D_∞) would give per-element bounds. Which is the right metric depends on the threat model.

2. **Tight bounds for intersection and NOT.** The intersection false positive rate from cross-element collisions in the trapdoor Boolean algebra needs a closed-form expression as a function of $|A|$, $|B|$, $|A \cap B|$, and n. For NOT, deriving $\eta_{\mathrm{NOT}}(|A|, n)$ would complete the parameter instantiation.

3. **Adaptive encoding granularity.** Can the entanglement parameter p be made adaptive—encoding pairs only for correlated values while encoding independent values separately?

4. **Noise-to-signal probability under composition.** Through a chain of m cipher maps, what is the probability that a filler query produces a decodable output at the end? Naively $1 - (1 - \varepsilon)^m$, but this assumes independence of the ε events across maps.

5. **Layered construction laws.** Do the three construction layers (undef, noise, cipher) satisfy formal algebraic laws in the approximate setting? If so, this would enable equational reasoning about cipher map constructions.

9.4 What This Framework Is Not

To set clear expectations:

- *Not ORAM.* ORAM hides access patterns by reshuffling storage with polylogarithmic overhead. Cipher maps use static total functions.

- *Not differential privacy.* Differential privacy bounds what can be learned about a *dataset* from a *query answer*. Cipher maps bound what an untrusted evaluator learns about a *function* from *opaque evaluations*.

- *Not simulation-based security.* We do not claim that the untrusted machine's view can be simulated. The guarantees are parameterized (δ, ε) rather than negligible in a security parameter.

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